

Life Story Wealth Planning — Website

Copy Draft

For Alex's review. Nine pages, in the order a visitor would move through them. Anything in italics inside brackets is something we still need from you.

*Each section shows an **intent** line above the copy — a single sentence describing what that section is meant to do for the reader. This is what design will serve. If a section's intent doesn't match what you want it to do, say so — the copy follows from the intent, not the other way around.*

Home

What this page does: Route a referred stranger to About within 30 seconds without making them feel pitched. Land three signals fast — this is the right person, this is a real firm, he thinks about this work differently.

Browser tab title: Life Story Wealth Planning — Alex Hilbert, Registered Investment Advisor, Scottsdale, Arizona

Search preview: A small Scottsdale investment advisory firm run by Alex Hilbert, a Registered Investment Advisor and fiduciary. Active portfolio management for people who have already built their wealth.

What is this money for?

[Alex — this replaces the earlier "for the life it belongs to" wording you flagged as awkward. Two alternates: "What do you want this money to do?" or "What is this money supposed to do?" Your call.]

Sub-line intent: *Locate the reader in one line — who is this, where, and am I in the right place — before they scroll.*

That question comes before any portfolio decision. My name is Alex Hilbert. I run Life Story Wealth Planning, a small investment advisory firm in Scottsdale, Arizona, for people who have already built their wealth and want it managed by someone who is actually managing it.

Why this firm exists

Intent: *Differentiate from the default adviser in one beat — by naming the industry's most common failure mode, not by claiming to be better.*

Most portfolios sit still. Markets move, and the portfolio does not. When markets fall, the standard answer clients hear from their adviser is to do nothing.

I do not think that is management. It is the absence of it.

I built this firm to work the other way. To actually manage portfolios — reviewed and reconstituted every quarter, moved between asset classes as conditions change, with the discretion to hold cash when nothing deserves capital. The process has a name. I call it

Zermagen, which is Hebrew for fortress and shield. It is explained in full on the Approach page.

Who this is for

Intent: *Let the wrong reader leave; let the right one recognise themselves in the first sentence.*

Most of my clients came to me because someone they trust suggested it. If that is how you arrived here, you are the person this site is written for. I work with a small number of individuals — usually approaching retirement or already in it, usually more focused on keeping what they have built than on growing it aggressively. The Who I work with page describes the fit in more detail.

[Alex — you used "families" once on our call. Deck uses "individuals" because your accounts are individually managed. Say if you'd prefer "families".]

What it costs

Intent: *Get the fee question out of the way early. Turn the anxiety point into a differentiator with a wait-what hook.*

Potentially nothing. There is no management fee. I am paid only on gains above a defined threshold — and if the strategy does not work in a given quarter, I do not get paid for that quarter. The exact wording, and what it means in plain language, is on the Fees page.

Where your money actually is

Intent: *Answer the unspoken "could this person take my money?" question before the reader has to ask it.*

I never hold client money. Your account is at a third-party custodian, in your own name — I direct how it is invested, and I cannot move funds out of it. The full explanation is on the Custody page.

The next step

Intent: *One low-friction ask, honestly framed. Not a hard CTA — a next page for the specific reader on the site right now.*

If you were referred to me, the page most people read next is About. If you would rather talk, start a conversation.

Button: Start a conversation →

Markets are people first and mathematics a distant third.

About

What this page does: Earn the referred stranger's trust well enough that they reach out. This is the page the whole site exists to route people to.

Browser tab title: About Alex Hilbert — Registered Investment Advisor, Scottsdale, Arizona | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: Alex Hilbert is a Registered Investment Advisor and fiduciary, formerly at Vanguard, now running Life Story Wealth Planning — a small Scottsdale investment advisory firm.

About Alex Hilbert

Registered Investment Advisor · Fiduciary · Scottsdale, Arizona

[Photograph of Alex goes here. Real photo, not stock, not AI.]

Photo intent: Humanise. Turn a name on a page into a person the reader is deciding whether to trust. Single highest-signal element on the site.

Who I am

Intent: Establish credentials and the fiduciary standard in the reader's own moment of due diligence. Also — win the name-search: his full name and Arizona must be unmistakable to Google.

My name is Alex Hilbert. I run Life Story Wealth Planning, a small investment advisory firm in Scottsdale, Arizona. I am a Registered Investment Advisor, which in the United States is a specific, licensed role — not a job title anyone can adopt. Being an RIA also means I am a fiduciary. I am legally required to put my clients' interests ahead of my own.

I have worked in this industry since 2012. Most of the people I work with came to me because someone they trust suggested it. If that is how you arrived here, this page is for you.

Why I built this firm

Intent: The emotional heart of the site. Convert credentials into character through a specific origin story. If the reader stops reading anywhere, stop them here.

Before this firm, I was an adviser at Vanguard.

The clients I spoke with there were smart people who had built real wealth over long careers. They read carefully, they asked real questions, and they were paying attention. When markets fell — and they always fall, eventually — those clients would call. They wanted to know what we were going to do about their portfolios. They watched the value of their accounts drop day after day, and they wanted a plan.

The Vanguard answer was to do nothing. Stay the course. Ride it out.

That answer was not wrong for everyone. For a lot of people it is the right answer. But the clients I spoke with were not satisfied with it. They wanted to know why they were paying a management fee if nothing was being managed. They had a fair point.

At Vanguard, we were trained to manage clients, not portfolios.

I do not say that as a criticism. It is true of most large firms, and there is a business reason for it. But it is not the way I want to work, and it is not what the clients I spoke with were paying for.

So I left, and I built this firm to do the other thing. To actually manage portfolios. To reconsider positions every quarter, to move between asset classes when conditions change, and to hold cash when nothing deserves capital. To answer the phone when a client wants to know what we are doing about a market that is falling — with something better than "nothing."

Most clients are not satisfied with an advisor who gets paid to sit on his hands.

That is why this firm exists.

What being a fiduciary means, in practice

Intent: Take an abstract legal word and convert it into three concrete, verifiable behaviours.

A fiduciary is legally required to act in your interest ahead of their own. In day-to-day terms that shapes three things about how I work:

- I do not earn commissions on the products I recommend. My fee structure pays me only when your portfolio gains value above a defined threshold. I do not get paid for holding your assets. I get paid when they grow.
- I do not take custody of your money. It is held at a separate, third-party institution in an account in your name.
- I do not answer to a corporate office. I answer to my clients. That is the point of the firm.

How I manage money

Intent: *Signpost only. Keep the About page emotional; send the reader to Approach for the mechanics.*

The process has a name — Zermagen, from the Hebrew for *fortress and shield*. It is built around a single idea: risk comes first. Before I decide what to buy, I decide what could go wrong and how to guard against it. The full explanation is on the Approach page.

Where I am

Intent: *Geographic anchor. Reinforces the name-search story and quietly signals scale — small on purpose.*

Life Story Wealth Planning is based in Scottsdale, Arizona.

I keep the firm small on purpose. It lets me pay attention to each client's situation properly rather than run a book of hundreds.

How to verify me

Intent: *Put the reader in control. Volunteering the verification path is itself a trust signal — advisors with something to hide don't do this.*

You can look up any Registered Investment Advisor in the United States through the SEC's public records. My firm's Form ADV — the standard regulatory filing — is linked in the footer of every page on this site. If it matters to you to verify anything before we speak, that is where to look.

A note on the name

Intent: *Pre-empt the confusion when the reader Googles the firm and hits an unrelated company with a similar name.*

There is an unrelated firm called Life Story Financial. I am not connected with them. This site — and my firm, Life Story Wealth Planning — belong to me.

Button: Start a conversation →

Approach

What this page does: Show intellectual specificity without publishing performance. Convert "he manages money" into "he thinks about it *this way*, not the default way."

Browser tab title: Approach — The Zermagen Process | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: How I manage portfolios: the Zermagen process — active, risk-first management built around the idea that markets run on liquidity, not on a fixed mix of stocks and bonds.

How I manage portfolios

The Zermagen process — active, risk-first, reconstituted quarterly.

What most people actually want

Intent: Name the reader's own quiet tension out loud before offering a resolution. They should feel understood before they feel sold to.

Most people who come to me want two things that the industry usually treats as opposites.

They want their money to be safer. They have already built what they have and they do not want to lose it.

They also want their money to grow. Inflation does not stop because you retired. Neither does life.

The standard trade-off is that you can pursue one or the other. Take less risk and accept lower returns, or reach for higher returns and accept the drawdowns that come with them. That trade-off is real at the extremes. It is less real in the middle, and the middle is where most of the work happens.

What I actually do

Intent: One-paragraph operating principle. The reader should be able to quote this back.

I hold parts of markets that are working — where money is flowing in, not out — and I move away from parts that are not. I hold cash when nothing deserves capital. I use protective positions when conditions call for them. The portfolio is reviewed every quarter and reconstituted from scratch, not tweaked at the margin.

What I actually watch

Intent: *Expose the belief. This is the intellectual differentiator. Give the reader something concrete (2022) to remember.*

My belief is that markets run on liquidity — on where money is moving, and why — more than on any fixed mix of stocks and bonds. That belief matters because the standard "diversified" portfolio can fail exactly when you think it will not. In 2022, the stock market fell and the bond market fell alongside it. A traditional 60/40 offered no shelter.

The Zermagen process is built around that reality. Instead of holding a fixed mix and hoping the mix protects you, I follow where money is actually moving between markets, and I move the portfolio with it. The framework has three layers.

Layer 1 · Narrow the Universe

Intent: *Show the process starts from the whole board, then narrows. He has considered what to exclude, not just what to include.*

I start with 21 asset classes covering global stocks, bonds, commodities and currencies. Based on current market conditions, I narrow that set to 7. This layer asks the largest question first: *given what markets are actually doing right now, where is it reasonable to be at all?*

[Simple diagram of the 21 → 7 narrowing here — need your sign-off.]

Layer 2 · Analyze the Constituents

Intent: *Show discrimination inside the shortlist. This is not a passive allocation dressed up.*

Within each of the 7 asset classes I look at the components — what actually makes up each class, and how each piece is behaving. The goal at this layer is to filter out excess downside risk and to remove laggards. Being in the right asset class is not enough on its own.

Layer 3 · Craft the Strategy

Intent: *Show that even after selection, there is a further decision about how to hold. The tools go beyond buy-and-sell.*

The third layer decides how to hold what remains. Depending on the situation I may buy outright, hold cash, sell covered calls, short-sell puts, hold limited futures exposure, or build long/short spreads. The right position is not always a simple purchase.

What runs through all three layers

Intent: *Convert process into values. The reader should recognise these as principles, not marketing bullets.*

- **Risk first.** How much can be lost in a bad year matters more than how much might be gained in a good one. Every decision is made in that order.
- **Built to move.** Positions are chosen to be reconsidered, not to be forgotten. Every quarter the whole portfolio is reviewed against current conditions.
- **Opportunity across markets.** I am not restricted to one asset class or geography.
- **Discretionary authority.** Under our agreement I have the authority to act when action is warranted, without waiting for approval on each move.
- **Cash is a position.** Holding cash is a decision, not the absence of one. When nothing deserves capital, the answer is to hold cash.
- **No leverage.** My clients want their money treated with care. I do not borrow against the portfolio to reach for larger returns.

Money moves between markets. So should your portfolio.

What this page does not show

Intent: *Turn a compliance absence into an intentional posture. The reader should read this and think "of course."*

I do not publish past performance figures, growth illustrations, or backtests on this site. There are specific rules about how advisers may present results, and I would rather have a conversation about them with you directly than post numbers on a marketing page.

Button: Start a conversation →

Who I work with

What this page does: Filter. The wrong reader leaves the site here without wasted time on either side. The right reader recognises themselves and moves toward Contact.

Browser tab title: Who I work with | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: A small number of individuals — usually approaching or in retirement, already wealthy, and interested in active risk management. Here is how to tell whether the firm is a fit.

Who I work with

Opening intent: Draw a specific, recognisable portrait — not a demographic profile. The right reader should feel described, not sorted.

Most of my clients spent thirty or forty years earning what they now want to protect. They are business owners, former executives, and professionals who reached the point where the game changed — the goal is no longer to build more, it is not to lose what is already there. Most were introduced to me by someone they trust. Most are approaching retirement or already in it. None of them are trying to get rich.

What we usually have in common

Intent: Sharpen the self-recognition. Four bullets, each one a mirror.

- You have built your wealth and are more focused on keeping it than on growing it aggressively.
- You want an actively managed portfolio — one that responds to what markets are doing, not one left on a fixed model and forgotten.
- You prefer to work directly with the person managing your money, not through layers of a large firm.
- You are careful. You read carefully, you ask real questions, and you make decisions in your own time.

When I am probably not the right fit

Intent: Genuine self-disqualification signals genuine self-knowledge — a trust marker. And it saves both sides a wasted conversation.

- You are early in building your wealth and are looking for aggressive growth.
- You want a portfolio you never look at, matched to a passive index and left alone.
- You want frequent trading based on short-term market calls.
- You want product recommendations paid for by commission.

If any of that describes you better, there are firms that fit that better than I do, and I will say so directly.

Button: Start a conversation →

Fees

What this page does: Neutralise the fee-anxiety of a referred prospect who has been told the fees here are unusual. Convert "unusual" into "aligned." Do it without any worked example.

Browser tab title: Fees — Results, not fees | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: No management fee. I am paid only on gains above a high water mark and a quarterly hurdle rate. If the strategy does not work, I do not get paid.

Results, not fees

What does this cost?

Intent: *The wait-what hook. Answer the question the reader came here to ask, then explain.*

Potentially nothing.

Most advisers charge a management fee. Whether your portfolio goes up, down, or sideways, the fee is charged. I do not. If the strategy I run for you does not work in a given quarter — if it does not exceed a defined threshold — I am not paid for that quarter. When it does exceed the threshold, I am paid a share of the excess. That is the whole model.

In my own words

Intent: *Legal fidelity. The exact wording is the wording that governs the arrangement.*

The wording below is exactly as I publish it. It is the wording that governs the fee arrangement.

"We charge no managements fees. We only make money by increasing your wealth. Performance success fees of 30% are assessed quarterly only on excess returns above a high water mark and a quarterly 1.5% hurdle rate."

[Alex — reproduced exactly, including the "managements" typo, pending your counsel's review.]

What that means, in plain language

Intent: *Translation without oversimplification. The careful reader should feel respected — not talked down to.*

Two things have to be true before I am paid anything.

- **Your account has to reach a new high.** This is the *high water mark*. If your portfolio drops and later recovers, no fee is charged on the recovered ground — the water mark is the previous peak. I am not paid twice on the same gains.
- **The new high has to be more than 1.5% above the previous one, for that quarter.** This is the *hurdle rate*. Small gains do not trigger a fee.

When both conditions are met, the fee is 30% of the gains above the hurdle. Otherwise, there is no fee for that quarter.

Why the model is built this way

Intent: *Convert an unusual fee structure into a values statement. Alignment is the point, not novelty.*

I built it this way so my incentives line up with yours. If you do well, I do well. If you do not do well, I do not do well. That is how I want the arrangement to work, and it is a large part of why the firm exists.

A note on incentives

Intent: *Pre-empt the sophisticated reader's next objection — "doesn't a performance fee encourage risk-taking?" — before they raise it.*

A fee structure paid on performance can, in theory, encourage an adviser to take more risk than they otherwise would, in the hope of triggering a fee. I am aware of that risk, and it is part of why my approach starts with risk management before anything else. The high water mark also helps: once a portfolio has fallen, I do not get paid on the recovery back to the previous peak, which removes any incentive to gamble the account back.

What this page deliberately does not show

Intent: *Same posture as Approach's equivalent section. Absence becomes intention.*

I do not publish worked examples, comparison charts, or illustrations of what someone "would have paid" under this fee. Doing so would represent past or hypothetical performance, which sits under specific rules for advisers. If you want to understand how the structure would apply to your situation, we can walk through it in a conversation.

Button: Start a conversation →

Custody

What this page does: Answer the unspoken fear directly — "could this person walk off with my money?" — with a structural answer, not a promise.

Browser tab title: Custody — where your money actually is | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: I never hold client money. Your account is at a third-party custodian, in your name. I direct how it is invested. I cannot move funds out of it.

Where your money actually is

The short version

Intent: Answer the fear in two sentences. Everything else on the page is elaboration.

I never hold client money.

Your account is at an independent, third-party custodian, in your own name. I direct how the money in it is invested. I cannot move funds out of it, to me or to anyone else. That distinction is the single most important structural safeguard in how I have set up the firm.

If you have ever read a story about an adviser who took client money, that story is almost always about an arrangement where the adviser controlled the account and could withdraw from it. That is not how this firm is set up, and under our agreement it cannot be set up that way.

How the account works

Intent: Mechanics for the careful reader who wants to verify the structure works the way the short version claimed.

- **The account is in your own name.** Not the firm's. Not a pooled fund.
- **Managed separately, not pooled with anyone else's.** Your holdings are yours.
- **You can see every holding and every value at the custodian.** Directly, without going through me and without asking me. It is your account.
- **A third-party custodian holds the assets.** The firm does not.

[Alex — do we want to name the custodian, or leave it general?]

Verifying any of this

Intent: *Same posture as About's "How to verify me" — volunteering the verification path is itself the trust signal.*

You do not have to take my word for it. My firm's registration and structure are public record. The Form ADV linked in the footer of this site is the standard filing that describes the arrangement, including the custody relationship. If it matters to you to verify anything before we talk, that is where to look.

Button: Start a conversation →

How we start

What this page does: Reduce commitment anxiety by making the on-ramp visible and reversible. The reader should finish thinking "I can start this without committing to anything."

Browser tab title: How we start — the roadmap from first conversation to client | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: A plain description of what happens between the first conversation and becoming a client — so you know what to expect at every step.

How we start

What this page is for

Intent: *Frame the page itself as a trust signal — advisors who spell out the process are not the ones you have to worry about.*

Deciding to work with someone who manages your money is a serious decision. This page describes what actually happens between the first conversation and the point where you are a client — so there are no surprises, and so you can decide at each step whether to continue. There is no pressure to move faster than you want to.

[Alex — the six steps below are placeholders. You mentioned you still need to define your onboarding process.]

Step 1 — First conversation

Intent: *Establish the lowest-friction entry point. What is this call, how long, does the reader need to prepare?*

[Your description of the introductory call.]

Step 2 — Understanding your situation

Intent: *Describe the information asked for so the reader can decide whether to share it.*

[What you ask, what a discovery conversation covers.]

Step 3 — A written proposal

Intent: Show that the offer is something the reader can read and consider on their own time.

[Whether you provide a written proposal, what it includes.]

Step 4 — Paperwork and account setup

Intent: Demystify the mechanics of becoming a client — nothing here should feel unfamiliar.

[The agreement, opening the account at the custodian, funding.]

Step 5 — First portfolio decisions

Intent: Show the reader what to expect in the first quarter, in what order, and with what visibility.

[How the initial portfolio is constructed, over what timeframe.]

Step 6 — Ongoing

Intent: Establish the cadence of the relationship — how often the reader will hear from you, and how they can reach you.

[Cadence of reviews, how clients receive statements, how to reach you.]

What you can expect throughout

Intent: Values in bullet form. These are commitments that apply across every step above.

- No pressure to decide on any timeline other than yours.
- Direct communication with me, not through an assistant.
- Written confirmation of any change to your account.
- Answers to questions you have not asked yet, if I think you should know something.

Button: Start a conversation →

Contact

What this page does: Convert a reader who has decided to reach out into a completed contact — with the least friction possible. Multiple paths for different comfort levels.

Browser tab title: Contact | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: Get in touch with Alex Hilbert at Life Story Wealth Planning in Scottsdale, Arizona.

Get in touch

The direct route

Intent: *Primary path. Warmer than a form, faster than a call — for the reader who wants a written first exchange.*

The easiest way to start is a short message. I will reply personally.

[Alex — please confirm which email address to publish.]

[And whether you want to publish a phone number.]

Book a call

Intent: *Secondary path. For the reader who prefers voice to text and would rather claim a time than wait for a reply.*

If you would rather book a time directly, you can schedule a first conversation here.

[Booking tool — we will wire this up once you tell us which tool to use.]

Where I am

Intent: *Geographic anchor and quiet name-search reinforcement.*

Life Story Wealth Planning is based in Scottsdale, Arizona.

Contact form

Intent: *Tertiary path — for the reader who wants a structured way to introduce themselves, especially the*

referral context.

Fields:

- Your name
- Your email
- Best phone number (optional)
- How you were referred (optional)
- A short note

Button: Send

Below the form: I will reply personally, usually within two business days.

[Alex — happy to promise "two business days" or drop the line entirely.]

Insights

What this page does: Hold a place for future substance without pretending to have it now. Empty honesty beats generic filler.

Browser tab title: Insights | Life Story Wealth Planning

Search preview: Written research and occasional notes on markets, risk management, and how I think about long-term investing.

Insights

What lives here

Intent: *Explain the absence and set the standard. This page will be worth reading when there is something worth reading — not before.*

This section will hold two things: a research white paper I am rebuilding, and occasional written notes on markets, risk, and how I think about long-term investing.

I am not going to fill this section with generic finance posts. It is going to be quiet until there is something worth reading, and then it will hold that.

(Empty state on the page:) No published items yet.

Footer (every page)

Intent: *Regulatory verification path + geographic + minimum legal. Volunteering these is itself a trust signal.*

- Life Story Wealth Planning · Scottsdale, AZ · [year]
- Link to **Form ADV** (SEC / IAPD lookup)
- Link to **FINRA BrokerCheck** (if applicable)
- Any required legal / compliance line

[Alex — regulatory disclosures from your counsel, not copied from another firm.]